

RISK vs. REWARD

How much would you bet you're right?

1-Hour Studio Game Show

Players: Solo Contestants or Couples

Prize Range: \$0.01 to \$1,000,000

LOGLINE

Contestants answer trivia questions—but before locking in an answer, they must decide how much they trust their choice. That decision determines how much they can win or lose, and shapes their path toward a \$1,000,000 prize.

THE HOOK

Everyone thinks they know the answer.

The real question is:

How much would you bet on yourself being right?

In RISK vs. REWARD, contestants don't just answer trivia—they continuously measure their own confidence under pressure, turning every question into a personal risk decision.

A correct answer is not enough. The size of your confidence in that answer determines your outcome.

CORE IDEA (ONE SENTENCE)

Before locking in each answer, contestants use a dynamic slider to set their confidence—directly determining their potential winnings, losses, and their evolving path to the top prize.

WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

This is not a trivia show where knowing the answer is enough.

It is a game where:

- confidence matters as much as knowledge
- every decision has lasting consequences
- and early choices permanently shape what is still possible

Two equally skilled players can leave with radically different outcomes based entirely on how they manage risk and confidence.

HOW IT PLAYS

- 12-question studio game (no elimination)
- Contestants choose a category each round (Science, History, Pop Culture, etc.)
- A multiple-choice question is revealed
- Contestant selects an answer first
- Contestant then sets confidence using a real-time slider
- Lock-in → result revealed immediately
- Winnings update dynamically after each question

THE DECISION ENGINE

Every question forces one core decision:

Do I trust myself enough to risk more for a bigger reward?

Higher confidence:

- increases potential winnings
- increases potential losses
- preserves access to the highest prize levels

Lower confidence:

- reduces immediate risk
- limits immediate reward
- permanently reduces future maximum earning potential

Every choice reshapes what is still possible later in the game.

THE GAME WITHIN THE GAME

Contestants are constantly managing two things:

- what they know
- how sure they are that they know it

This creates a continuous psychological tension: confidence vs. caution, played out in real money in real time.

COUPLES MODE

Two contestants play as a team, jointly deciding answers and confidence levels.

This turns every question into negotiation under pressure:

- disagreement becomes strategy
- persuasion becomes gameplay
- confidence gaps become conflict

Often, the biggest tension is not the trivia—it is agreement on risk.

WHY IT WORKS

RISK vs. REWARD turns confidence into something viewers can actually watch:

- Viewers instantly compare their own confidence to contestants
- Every question creates a second game at home
- Every decision has immediate and long-term consequences
- The game creates natural regret and “I would’ve done it differently” moments
- Real-time dollar shifts make outcomes easy to understand
- Couples Mode adds relationship tension and personality conflict

At its core, it is not about knowing answers.

It is about deciding how much you trust your own answers when money is on the line.

INTERACTIVE DEMO (PLAYABLE)

A fully interactive prototype demonstrates the complete game system in real time.

Players select categories, answer questions, and adjust confidence using a dynamic slider that instantly updates winnings, risk exposure, and future winning potential before locking in decisions.

👉 <https://eddielawhorn.com/risk-vs-reward/game>

TAGLINE

Knowing the answer is only half the game.

Knowing how much to trust it wins the money.

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